Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/mike-smith-2932b623 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Command
Leadership
Special Operations

Certifications

Top Secret/SCI
Military Freefall Parachutist
Joint Terminal Attack Controller (Weapons Officer / Instructor / Evaluator)
Chief of Staff Launchpad

Honors-Awards

US Air Forces Europe Pitsenbarger Award for Heroism
US Air Forces in Europe: Special Warfare NCO of the Year - 2003
Top Graduate - USAF Officer Training School
Major General John R. Alison Award for Character and Innovation
AFSOC Squadron of the Year (Commander)

Publications

JTAC Debriefing Guide
Making History at USAF Weapons School
USAF Weapons School Graduates First-Ever JTAC Instructors
Stars and Stripes Heroes 2010
Special Tactics: Cyber Warfare Is The New Precision Strike

Mike Smith

Defense Innovation, Quality Control, Human Performance
United States

Summary

Executive integrator with a passion for innovation, development, and comprehensive debriefing. Pressure-tested and focused on solving difficult problems.

Experience

Darkhive
Chief of Staff
August 2025 - Present (10 months)
United States

Black Rifle Coffee Company
Media Producer (Skillbridge Internship)
May 2025 - August 2025 (4 months)
United States

Media, community engagement, and marketing internship

320th Special Tactics Squadron
Commander
May 2022 - April 2024 (2 years)
Okinawa, Japan

AFSOC Squadron of the Year for 2022

Joint Special Operations Command
Task Force Director
May 2021 - May 2022 (1 year 1 month)
North Carolina, United States

Task Force Director and Cross-Functional Team Lead

Daniel K. Inouye Asia Pacific Center for Security Studies
Strategic Policy Fellow
June 2020 - June 2021 (1 year 1 month)
Hawaii, United States

321st Special Tactics Squadron
Director of Operations
June 2018 - June 2020 (2 years 1 month)
Mildenhall, England, United Kingdom

720th Special Tactics Group
Chief of Weapons and Tactics
September 2016 - June 2018 (1 year 10 months)
Florida, United States

United States Air Force
Joint Terminal Attack Controller (Instructor/Evaluator/Weapons Officer)
September 1998 - July 2017 (18 years 11 months)
Worldwide

17th Special Tactics Squadron / Detachment 2
Commander
July 2014 - August 2016 (2 years 2 months)
Washington, United States

2d Ranger Battalion

66th Weapons Squadron
Commander & Founder, JTAC Weapons Instructor Course
March 2012 - August 2014 (2 years 6 months)
Las Vegas, NV

Education

USAF Weapons School
JTAC Weapons Instructor (Initial Cadre), Close Air Support / Joint Fires Integration · (2012 - 2012)

Asia Pacific Center for Security Studies
· (June 2020 - June 2021)

USAF Air Command and Staff College
Master’s Degree, Master's of Military Operational Art and Science - Operational Warfare Concentration · (2018 - 2019)

Aspen Institute

Executive Leadership Seminar · (October 2024)